Qiyuan Zheng

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Graduate Studies

Princeton University *2021-present*

PhD Candidate in Economics
Expected Completion Date: June 2027

References

Professor Pietro Ortoleva
Department of Economics
Princeton University
609-986-6895
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Professor Xiaosheng Mu
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Princeton University
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Professor Sylvain Chassang
Department of Economics
Princeton University
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Prior Education

Wesleyan University *2020-2021*

M.A. in Mathematics

Wesleyan University *2016-2020*

B.A. in Economics and Mathematics

Fields

PRIMARY Microeconomic Theory

SECONDARY Behavioral Economics

Job Market Paper

"Regulating Discretion: Information Design with Privately Known Common Interests" 2026.

A principal regulates the information of an agent who privately knows which statistic of the state determines both parties' payoffs from his action. The agent's payoff is this common component plus a bias: a second statistic that does not vary with his private information. When the statistics are correlated, the principal faces a trade-off: information that helps the agent optimize the common component may also tilt his action toward his bias. I develop a multidimensional model to study this setting: the relevant statistic is a weighted average of two merit dimensions of the state, and the bias is a third dimension. The private information of the agent is the weight of the merit dimensions. I show that every experiment in it is a weighted scoring rule: the agent takes the action if and only if a weighted sum of the merit dimensions exceeds a threshold that may depend on the bias dimension. Further, the optimal menu features distortions along the merit dimensions: the scoring rule an agent selects generally weighs them differently from the common relevant statistic.

Working Papers

1. "Strategically Ambiguous Deterrence." With Yiying Tan. 2026.
2. "Can Fact-Checking Backfire? Mixing Information When the Source Is Hidden" 2026.

Work in Progress

1. "Multi-Stage Application Processes for Distributional Concerns" 2026.

Research Experience

2022 Research Assistant to Prof. Sylvain Chassang

Teaching

Princeton ECO 501: Graduate Microeconomics I (TA, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025)

ECO 300: Undergraduate Microeconomics (TA, Spring 2024)

Professional Activities

Refereeing

American Economic Review

Honors, Scholarships, Fellowships, and Grants

Goldfeld Summer Fellowship, Princeton University *2025*

William S. Dietrich II Economic Theory Center Summer Grant, Princeton University *2024*

Marimar & Cristina Torres Prize, Princeton University *2023*

Languages

Chinese (native), English

Last updated: October 2026